



Product, price, promotion, and place make up the “4Ps,” the traditional marketing mix. Today, many businesses use the newer “4C” mix that combines commodity, cost, communication, and convenience. This approach shows the increasing importance of focusing on your customers and their experience and of seeking out niche rather than mass markets. To get it right, you must define and analyze your target market, then examine each element in the marketing mix to ensure that it will attract customers and meet their expectations.

“The 4Ps was about ‘What does the marketer want to say?’ while the 4Cs asks ‘What does the customer need to hear that the marketer can say?’”

Robert F. Lauterborn, originator of the 4Cs



## PROMOTION

- › Which combination of marketing channels and materials will be most effective?
- › What type of promotions do customers generally prefer?
- › When are customers most likely to respond to promotional calls to purchase?



## PLACE

- › Where do customers prefer to shop for products such as this?
- › Which distribution channel is preferred? Is it online, shops, or catalogs?
- › How can this offering stand out from competitors' products sold in the same place?

## 7Ps

In addition to the original 4Ps, some companies use a model that adds these extra 3Ps:

- › **People** Are they the ideal mix to create a team that exceeds customer expectations with the best level of service?
- › **Process** Are order-processing, and customer complaint and query systems in place and sufficiently effective?
- › **Physical environment** Is the place or website from which the product is sold attractive enough?

## COMMUNICATION

- › What type of messages get the best customer response?
- › What marketing information will interest your customers?
- › How do customers prefer to receive marketing messages? Are the messages relevant to them?

## CONVENIENCE

- › How convenient is it for busy customers to find, buy, and get the product into their hands?
- › What can be done to make this process as simple and straightforward as possible?

## 7Cs

To the original 4Cs, some businesses add an extra 3Cs. These are:

- › **Corporation** Does the company structure, its competitors, or stakeholders unduly influence the marketing drive and results?
- › **Consumer** Do you know what the customer needs and wants, and do the marketing materials and product itself address this?
- › **Circumstances** Can the business cope with adverse external factors that might impact sales?